

NARRATIVE WRITING

Telling a story that moves forward



1 What is it?

Narrative Writing

Narrative writing tells a **story** — a sequence of events involving characters, building through a beginning, middle and end, usually driven by a problem or change.

character + event + change

2 See it in action

A simple narrative

She opened the letter, and everything changed. An event that sets a story moving.

Building conflict

He knew the moment he saw her face that something was wrong.

A turning point

It was the last time she would ever trust him again.

Resolution

By the time the sun rose, nothing was the same — but she finally felt free.



Look here!

Before you write, decide **what changes** for your character between the first line and the last — that change is the actual story.

FUN FACT

Almost every story ever told follows some version of the same shape — a character wants something, faces obstacles, and is changed by the attempt, whether they succeed or fail.

3 Why writers use it

Narrative Writing helps writers: engage a reader emotionally through character and event, build tension and curiosity about what happens next, and explore a theme or idea through action rather than direct explanation.

Good narrative writing usually centres on a single moment of change — readers stay hooked because they want to know how a character is different by the end.

4 Where you'll spot it

Short stories & novels

Every narrative needs SOME kind of event or change — a story where nothing happens rarely holds a reader.

Exam creative writing tasks

Narrative prompts ("Write about a journey...") ask you to build a story, not just describe a scene.



Watch out!

A narrative needs a **change**, not just an event — "she walked to the shop and bought milk" isn't really a story unless something shifts for the character along the way.



You got this!

Ask what your character **wants** and what's stopping them — even a short piece of narrative writing needs some kind of obstacle to feel like a real story.

5 Quick recap

Tells a sequence of events

Centres on character and change

Has a beginning, middle, end



Good spot!

Try writing the same tiny event (missing a bus) as a full narrative with a character who wants something and is changed by missing it — notice how it becomes a story, not just a fact.